

# An Introduction to a Tensor

## Definition 0.1: Tensors

A tensor is a multi-dimensional array, generalizing the concept of scalars (0th-order tensors), vectors (1st-order tensors), and matrices (2nd-order tensors). A tensor of order  $N$  has  $N$  modes or dimensions.

### Notation:

- A tensor is denoted as  $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{I_1 \times I_2 \times \dots \times I_N}$ , where  $I_n$  represents the size along the  $n$ -th mode.
- A specific entry of  $\mathcal{A}$  is represented as  $a_{i_1 i_2 \dots i_N}$ .

# Examples of Tensors by Order

- ▶ **Order 0 (Scalar):**

A single number:

$$\mathcal{A} = 5$$

- ▶ **Order 1 (Vector):**

A 1-dimensional array:

$$\mathcal{A} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \\ 3 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{R}^3.$$

- ▶ **Order 2 (Matrix):**

A 2-dimensional array:

$$\mathcal{A} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 3 & 4 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{2 \times 2}.$$

# Examples of Tensors by Order Contrn'd...

## ► Order 3 (Tensor):

A 3-dimensional array:

$$\mathcal{A}(:, :, 1) = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathcal{A}(:, :, 2) = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 3 \\ 4 & 5 \end{bmatrix},$$

$$\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{2 \times 2 \times 2}.$$

# Example: Tensor Addition

## Given Tensors:

Two tensors of the same dimensions  $\mathcal{A}, \mathcal{B} \in \mathbb{R}^{2 \times 2 \times 2}$ :

$$\mathcal{A}(:, :, 1) = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 3 & 4 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathcal{A}(:, :, 2) = \begin{bmatrix} 5 & 6 \\ 7 & 8 \end{bmatrix},$$

$$\mathcal{B}(:, :, 1) = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathcal{B}(:, :, 2) = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 2 \\ 2 & 2 \end{bmatrix}.$$

## Addition:

$$\mathcal{C} = \mathcal{A} + \mathcal{B}, \quad \mathcal{C}(:, :, k) = \mathcal{A}(:, :, k) + \mathcal{B}(:, :, k).$$

## Result:

$$\mathcal{C}(:, :, 1) = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 \\ 4 & 4 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathcal{C}(:, :, 2) = \begin{bmatrix} 7 & 8 \\ 9 & 10 \end{bmatrix}.$$

# Example: Scalar Multiplication

## Given Tensor:

Tensor  $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{2 \times 2 \times 2}$ :

$$\mathcal{A}(:, :, 1) = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 3 & 4 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathcal{A}(:, :, 2) = \begin{bmatrix} 5 & 6 \\ 7 & 8 \end{bmatrix}.$$

## Scalar Multiplication:

Multiply  $\mathcal{A}$  by a scalar  $\alpha = 3$ :

$$\mathcal{B} = \alpha \cdot \mathcal{A}, \quad \mathcal{B}(:, :, k) = \alpha \cdot \mathcal{A}(:, :, k).$$

## Result:

$$\mathcal{B}(:, :, 1) = \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 6 \\ 9 & 12 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathcal{B}(:, :, 2) = \begin{bmatrix} 15 & 18 \\ 21 & 24 \end{bmatrix}.$$

# Introduction to Mode-n Product

- ▶ The **Mode-n product** is a generalization of matrix multiplication for tensors.
- ▶ Denoted as:  $\mathcal{B} = \mathcal{A} \times_n M$ .
- ▶ Involves multiplication of a matrix  $M$  with the  $n$ -th mode of tensor  $\mathcal{A}$ .
- ▶ Examples: **Mode-1**, **Mode-2**, and **Mode-3** products.

# Tensor-Times-Matrix (TTM) Operation

## Definition 0.2: Mode- $n$ Product

The  $n$ -mode product of a tensor  $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{I_1 \times \cdots \times I_N}$  and a matrix  $M \in \mathbb{R}^{J \times I_n}$  is denoted by:

$$\mathcal{B} = \mathcal{A} \times_n M,$$

where  $\mathcal{B} \in \mathbb{R}^{I_1 \times \cdots \times I_{n-1} \times J \times I_{n+1} \times \cdots \times I_N}$ .

### Steps:

1. **Unfold the tensor:** Convert  $\mathcal{A}$  into its mode- $n$  unfolding  $A_{(n)} \in \mathbb{R}^{I_n \times (I_1 \cdots I_{n-1} I_{n+1} \cdots I_N)}$ .
2. **Matrix multiplication:** Multiply  $M$  with  $A_{(n)}$ :

$$B_{(n)} = M \cdot A_{(n)}.$$

3. **Fold the result:** Transform  $B_{(n)}$  back into the tensor  $\mathcal{B}$  using the fold operation.

# Example 1: Mode-1 Product

## Question 0.1:

**Given Tensor:**  $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{2 \times 3 \times 2}$

$$\mathcal{A}(:, :, 1) = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 4 & 5 & 6 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathcal{A}(:, :, 2) = \begin{bmatrix} 7 & 8 & 9 \\ 10 & 11 & 12 \end{bmatrix}.$$

**Given Matrix:**  $M \in \mathbb{R}^{4 \times 2}$

$$M = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

**Goal:** Compute  $\mathcal{B} = \mathcal{A} \times_1 M$ , where  $\mathcal{B} \in \mathbb{R}^{4 \times 3 \times 2}$ .



# Mode-1 Product: Solution Steps

## Step 1: Unfold the Tensor

$$A_{(1)} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 7 & 8 & 9 \\ 4 & 5 & 6 & 10 & 11 & 12 \end{bmatrix}, \quad A_{(1)} \in \mathbb{R}^{2 \times 6}.$$

## Step 2: Matrix Multiplication

$$B_{(1)} = M \cdot A_{(1)} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 7 & 8 & 9 \\ 4 & 5 & 6 & 10 & 11 & 12 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Result:

$$B_{(1)} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 7 & 8 & 9 \\ 4 & 5 & 6 & 10 & 11 & 12 \\ 5 & 7 & 9 & 17 & 19 & 21 \\ 4 & 5 & 6 & 10 & 11 & 12 \end{bmatrix}.$$

# Mode-1 Product: Reshape

## Step 3: Reshape Back into Tensor

- ▶ Reshape  $B_{(1)} \in \mathbb{R}^{4 \times 6}$  into  $\mathcal{B} \in \mathbb{R}^{4 \times 3 \times 2}$ .
- ▶ Slices:

$$\mathcal{B}(:, :, 1) = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 4 & 5 & 6 \\ 5 & 7 & 9 \\ 4 & 5 & 6 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathcal{B}(:, :, 2) = \begin{bmatrix} 7 & 8 & 9 \\ 10 & 11 & 12 \\ 17 & 19 & 21 \\ 10 & 11 & 12 \end{bmatrix}.$$

## Example 2: Mode-2 Product

### Question 0.2:

**Given Tensor:**  $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{2 \times 3 \times 2}$

$$\mathcal{A}(:, :, 1) = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 4 & 5 & 6 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathcal{A}(:, :, 2) = \begin{bmatrix} 7 & 8 & 9 \\ 10 & 11 & 12 \end{bmatrix}.$$

**Given Matrix:**  $M \in \mathbb{R}^{5 \times 3}$

$$M = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}.$$

**Goal:** Compute  $\mathcal{B} = \mathcal{A} \times_2 M$ , where  $\mathcal{B} \in \mathbb{R}^{2 \times 5 \times 2}$ .

# Mode-2 Product: Solution Steps

## Step 1: Unfold the Tensor

$$A_{(2)} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 4 & 7 & 10 \\ 2 & 5 & 8 & 11 \\ 3 & 6 & 9 & 12 \end{bmatrix}, \quad A_{(2)} \in \mathbb{R}^{3 \times 4}.$$

## Step 2: Matrix Multiplication

$$B_{(2)} = M \cdot A_{(2)} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 4 & 7 & 10 \\ 2 & 5 & 8 & 11 \\ 3 & 6 & 9 & 12 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Result:

$$B_{(2)} = \begin{bmatrix} 4 & 10 & 16 & 22 \\ 2 & 5 & 8 & 11 \\ 6 & 15 & 24 & 33 \\ 3 & 6 & 9 & 12 \\ 1 & 4 & 7 & 10 \end{bmatrix}.$$

## Mode-2 Product: Reshape

### Step 3: Reshape Back into a Tensor

- ▶ Reshape  $B_{(2)} \in \mathbb{R}^{5 \times 4}$  into  $\mathcal{B} \in \mathbb{R}^{2 \times 5 \times 2}$ .
- ▶ Slices:

$$\mathcal{B}(:, :, 1) = \begin{bmatrix} 4 & 2 & 6 & 3 & 1 \\ 10 & 5 & 15 & 6 & 4 \end{bmatrix},$$

$$\mathcal{B}(:, :, 2) = \begin{bmatrix} 16 & 8 & 24 & 9 & 7 \\ 22 & 11 & 33 & 12 & 10 \end{bmatrix}.$$

## Example 3: Mode-3 Product

### Question 0.3:

**Given Tensor:**  $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{2 \times 3 \times 2}$

$$\mathcal{A}(:, :, 1) = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 4 & 5 & 6 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathcal{A}(:, :, 2) = \begin{bmatrix} 7 & 8 & 9 \\ 10 & 11 & 12 \end{bmatrix}.$$

**Given Matrix:**  $M \in \mathbb{R}^{3 \times 2}$

$$M = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

**Goal:** Compute  $\mathcal{B} = \mathcal{A} \times_3 M$ , where  $\mathcal{B} \in \mathbb{R}^{2 \times 3 \times 3}$ .

# Mode-3 Product: Solution

## Step 1: Unfold the Tensor

$$A_{(3)} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 7 & 8 & 9 \\ 4 & 5 & 6 & 10 & 11 & 12 \end{bmatrix}, \quad A_{(3)} \in \mathbb{R}^{2 \times 6}.$$

## Step 2: Matrix Multiplication

$$B_{(3)} = MA_{(3)}$$

## Result:

$$B_{(3)} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 7 & 8 & 9 \\ 4 & 5 & 6 & 10 & 11 & 12 \end{bmatrix}$$

# Mode-3 Product: Reshape Back

## Step 3: Reshape Back into Tensor

- ▶ Reshape  $B_{(3)} \in \mathbb{R}^{3 \times 6}$  into  $\mathcal{B} \in \mathbb{R}^{2 \times 3 \times 3}$ .
- ▶ Final Tensor  $\mathcal{B}$  has updated slices.



## Higher Order Singular Value Decomposition(HOSVD)

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## Simple Example: Just to Give an Idea

### Question 0.4:

**Given Tensor:**  $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{2 \times 1 \times 2}$

$$\mathcal{A}(:, :, 1) = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathcal{A}(:, :, 2) = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 4 \end{bmatrix}.$$

**Goal:** compute the Tensor SVD (T-SVD). Find:

- ▶ Core tensor  $\mathcal{S}$ ,
- ▶ Factor matrices  $U^{(1)}$ ,  $U^{(2)}$ , and  $U^{(3)}$ .

# Step 1: Mode-1,2,3 Unfolding

► **Mode-1 unfolding:**

$$A_{(1)} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 4 \end{bmatrix},$$

► **Mode-2 unfolding:**

$$A_{(2)} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 4 \end{bmatrix},$$

► **Mode-3 unfolding:**

$$A_{(3)} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 4 \end{bmatrix}.$$

## Step 2: Perform SVD (Mode-1 Unfolding)

The SVD of  $A_{(1)} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 4 \end{bmatrix}$ :

$$A_{(1)} = U_1 \Sigma_1 V_1^T,$$

where:

$$U_1 = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \Sigma_1 = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 4 \end{bmatrix}, \quad V_1 = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

## Step 2: Perform SVD (Mode-2 Unfolding)

The SVD of  $A_{(2)} = [1 \ 0 \ 0 \ 4]$ :

$$A_{(2)} = U_2 \Sigma_2 V_2^T,$$

where:

$$U_2 = [1], \quad \Sigma_2 = [\sqrt{17}], \quad V_2 = \begin{bmatrix} \frac{1}{\sqrt{17}} & 0 & 0 & \frac{4}{\sqrt{17}} \end{bmatrix}.$$

## Step 2: Perform SVD (Mode-3 Unfolding)

The SVD of  $A_{(3)} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 4 \end{bmatrix}$ :

$$A_{(3)} = U_{23} \Sigma_3 V_3^T,$$

where:

$$U_3 = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \Sigma_3 = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 4 \end{bmatrix}, \quad V_3 = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

## Step 3: Compute the Core Tensor

The core tensor is computed as:

$$\mathcal{S} = \mathcal{A} \times_1 (U_1)^T \times_2 (U_2)^T \times_3 (U_3)^T.$$

Here, since  $U_1, U_2, U_3$  are identity matrices,  $\mathcal{S} = \mathcal{A}$ :

$$\mathcal{A} = \left[ \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}, \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 4 \end{bmatrix} \right].$$

## Step 4: Reconstruction

The original tensor can be reconstructed as:

$$\mathcal{A} = \mathcal{S} \times_1 U_1 \times_2 U_2 \times_3 U_3.$$

Substituting the values of  $U_1, U_2, U_3$ :

$$\mathcal{A} = \left[ \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}, \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 4 \end{bmatrix} \right].$$



# HOSVD of Tensor of Order $\mathbb{R}^{2 \times 3 \times 2}$

## Question 0.5:

**Given Tensor:**  $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{2 \times 3 \times 2}$ :

$$\mathcal{A}(:, :, 1) = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 4 & 5 & 6 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathcal{A}(:, :, 2) = \begin{bmatrix} 7 & 8 & 9 \\ 10 & 11 & 12 \end{bmatrix}.$$

**Goal:** HOSVD to decompose  $\mathcal{A}$  into:

$$\mathcal{A} = \mathcal{G} \times_1 U_1 \times_2 U_2 \times_3 U_3,$$

where:

- ▶  $\mathcal{G}$  is the core tensor,
- ▶  $U_1, U_2, U_3$  are orthogonal matrices (of left singular vectors) for each mode.

# Step 1: Unfolding the Tensor

Unfold the tensor  $\mathcal{A}$  along each mode:

► **Mode-1 unfolding:**

$$A_{(1)} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 7 & 8 & 9 \\ 4 & 5 & 6 & 10 & 11 & 12 \end{bmatrix}.$$

► **Mode-2 unfolding:**

$$A_{(2)} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 4 & 7 & 10 \\ 2 & 5 & 8 & 11 \\ 3 & 6 & 9 & 12 \end{bmatrix}.$$

► **Mode-3 unfolding:**

$$A_{(3)} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 & 6 \\ 7 & 8 & 9 & 10 & 11 & 12 \end{bmatrix}.$$

## Step 2: SVD for Each Mode

Perform SVD on the unfolded matrices.

► **Mode-1 unfolding:**

$$A_{(1)} = U_1 \Sigma_1 V_1^T,$$

where:

$$U_1 = \begin{bmatrix} -0.37 & -0.93 \\ -0.93 & 0.37 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \Sigma_1 = \begin{bmatrix} 25.46 & 0 \\ 0 & 1.29 \end{bmatrix}.$$

► **Mode-2 unfolding:**

$$A_{(2)} = U_2 \Sigma_2 V_2^T,$$

where:

$$U_2 = \begin{bmatrix} -0.43 & 0.81 & 0.39 \\ -0.56 & -0.58 & 0.59 \\ -0.71 & -0.04 & -0.70 \end{bmatrix}.$$

## Step 2: SVD for Each Mode Contrn'd...

► **Mode-3 unfolding:**

$$A_{(3)} = U_3 \Sigma_3 V_3^T,$$

where:

$$U_3 = \begin{bmatrix} -0.55 & -0.83 \\ -0.83 & 0.55 \end{bmatrix}.$$

## Step 3: Compute the Core Tensor

The core tensor  $\mathcal{S}$  is computed as:

$$\mathcal{S} = \mathcal{A} \times_1 U_1^T \times_2 U_2^T \times_3 U_3^T.$$

This results in a compact representation of the original tensor.

# Final Decomposition

The tensor  $\mathcal{A}$  is now represented as:

$$\mathcal{A} = \mathcal{S} \times_1 U_1 \times_2 U_2 \times_3 U_3,$$

where:

- ▶  $U_1, U_2, U_3$  are the orthogonal factor matrices for each mode.
- ▶  $\mathcal{S}$  is the core tensor, capturing the essence of  $\mathcal{A}$ .

This decomposition helps in dimensionality reduction, compression, and feature extraction.